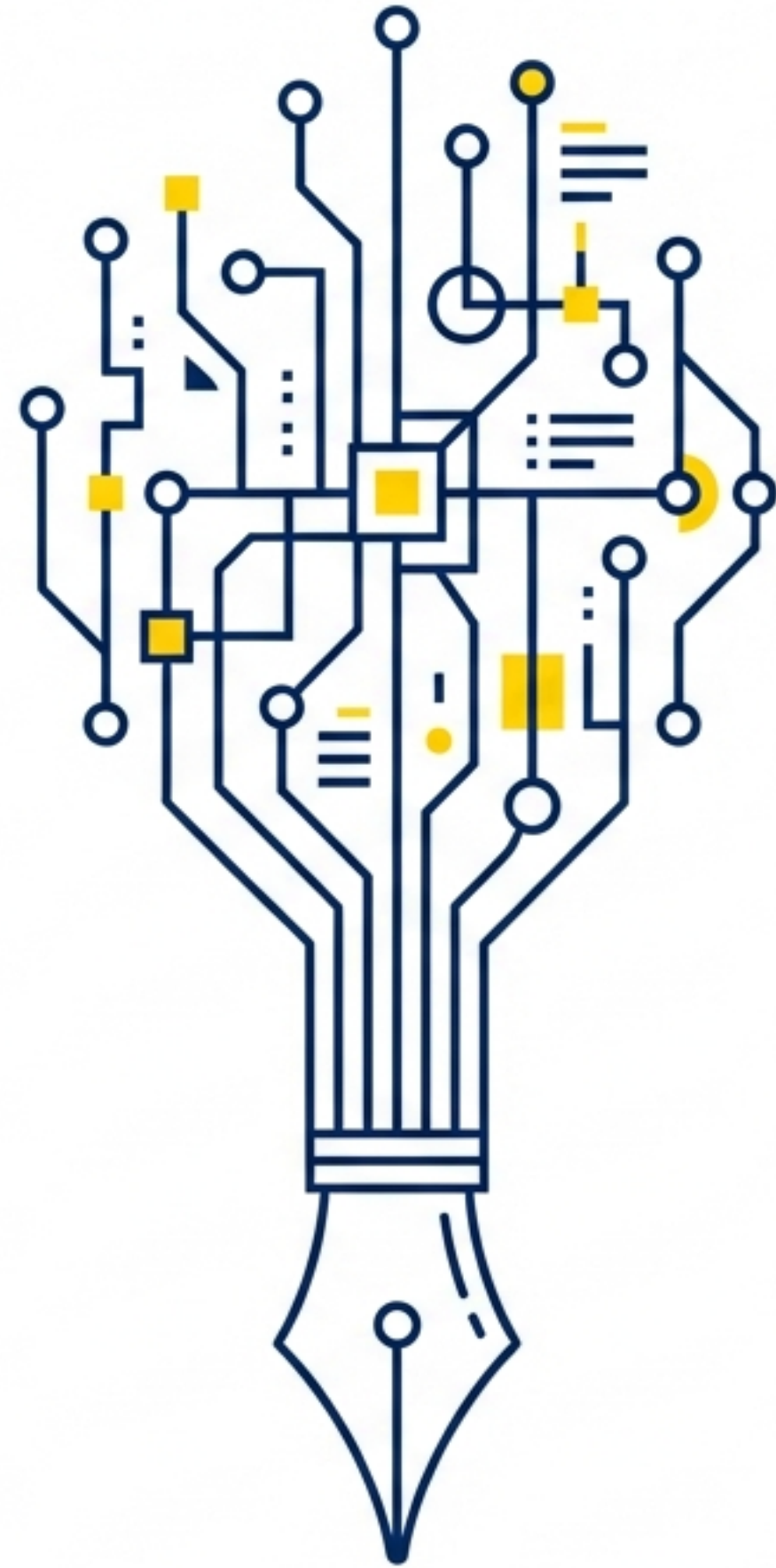


The TMU Graduate Research-A-Thon

**Incubating Ideas.
Building Community.
Breaking Silos.**

A proposal by the TMU Computer Science Graduate Student Union for a discipline-neutral STEM event.





The Graduate Paradox

- **Isolation**
Students lack community outside their immediate lab.
- **Risk Aversion**
Lack of safe spaces to test unconventional hypotheses.
- **Funding Gaps**
Limited support to develop grant-writing skills.

**“Surrounded by Brilliance,
Working in Isolation.”**

Redefining the Hackathon for Research



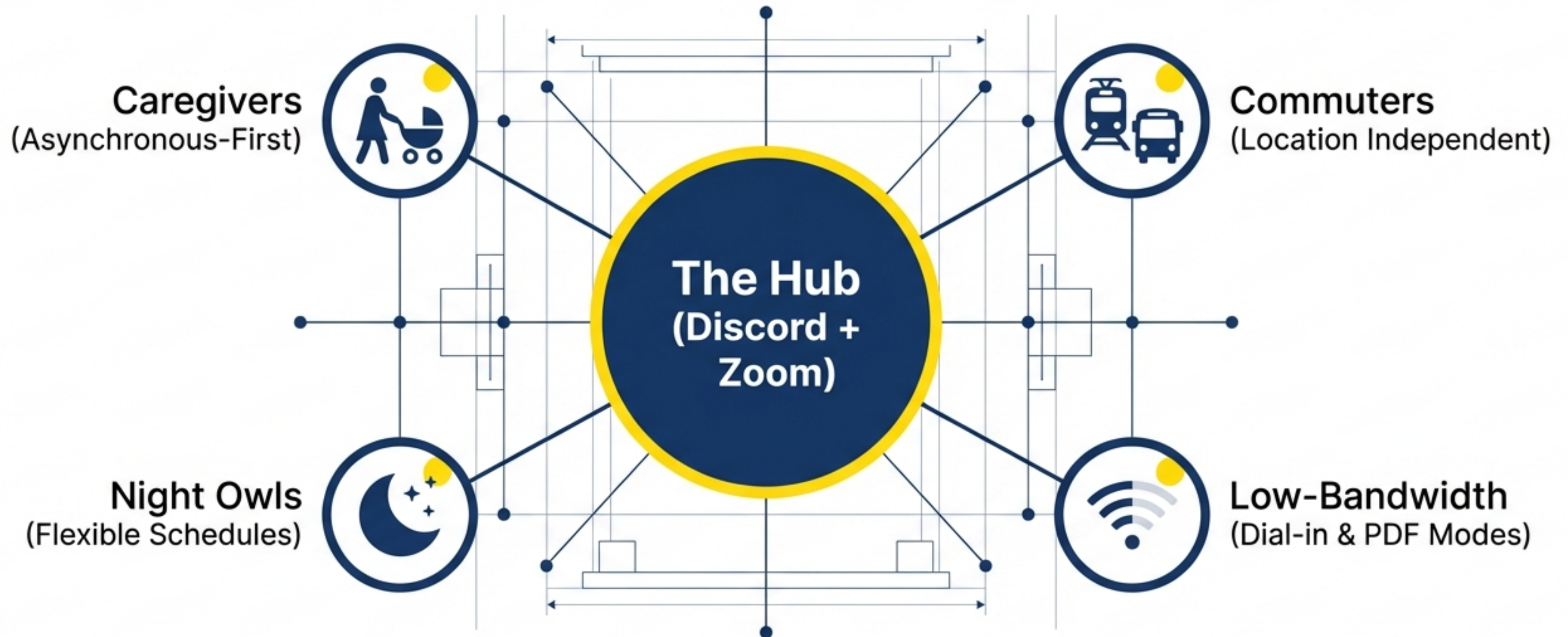
**The Old Model: 24-Hour
Coding Sprints. Sleep
Deprivation. Flashy Demos.**



**The New Model: 2-Week
Strategy. Proposal Writing.
Grant Feasibility.**

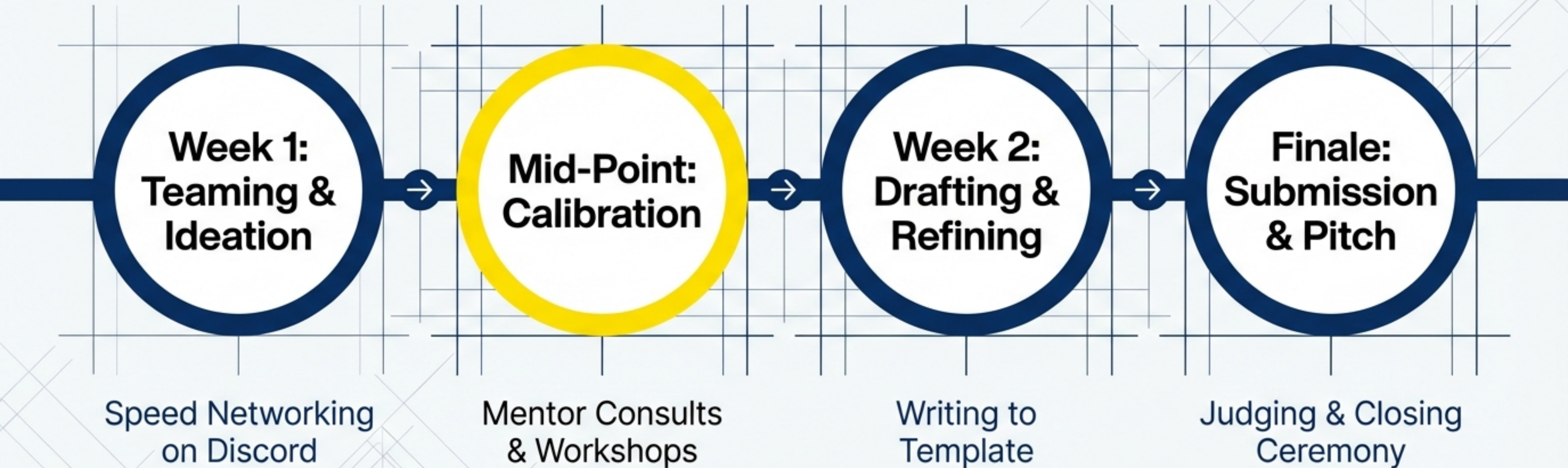
A build sprint for concepts, not code.

Radical Inclusivity via a Virtual Venue



Safety: Clear Code of Conduct & Anonymous Reporting.

The Two-Week Engine



Modern Rigour: Triangulated Evaluation



Tangible Career Assets



The Proposal

3-Page PDF (Methodology, Impact)



The Pitch

3-Minute Recorded Presentation



The Abstract

Citable One-Page Summary

ROI: Ready for scholarship applications, thesis chapters, and seed grants, Inter Regular.

Professional Operations Structure



The 'Shield': Risk Mitigation Strategy



****Tech Failure →**



Backup Google Meet links & Low-bandwidth mode.

****Evaluation Bias →**



Anonymized PDFs & Normalized scores.

****IP Concerns →**



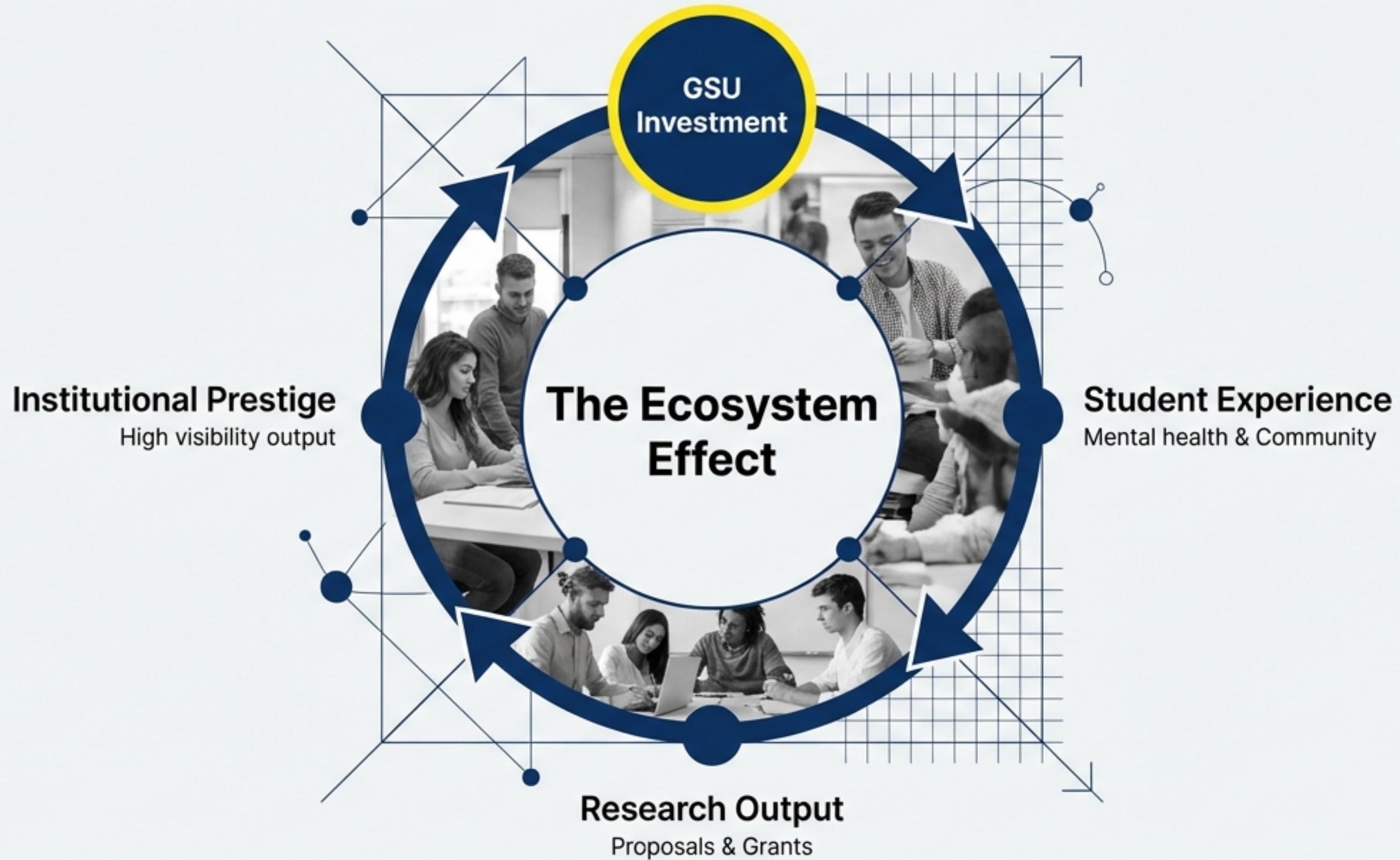
'Double-blind' review & IP retained by teams.

****Safety →**



Role-gated channels & Anonymous reporting.

Value Proposition to the University



Scalable Financial Support Models

Tier 1: Cash Seed Grants

Preferred Model

Preferred Model. \$3,000 Top Prize. Funds research accounts or awards.



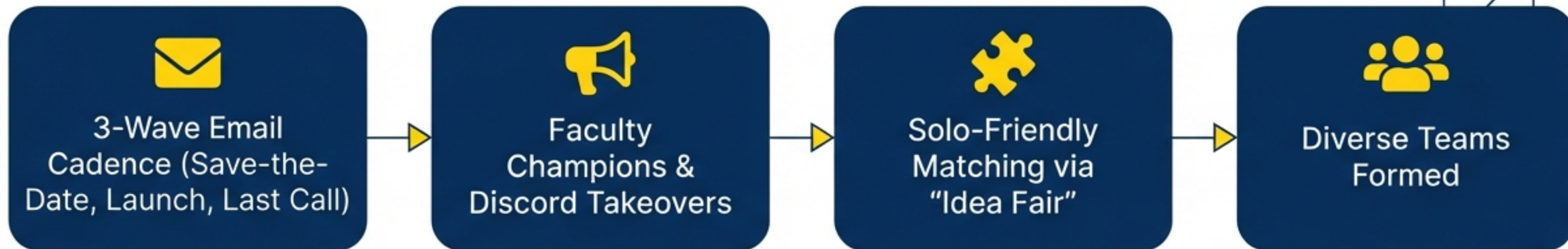
Tier 2: Career Catalysts

Guaranteed interviews or internships with industry partners.

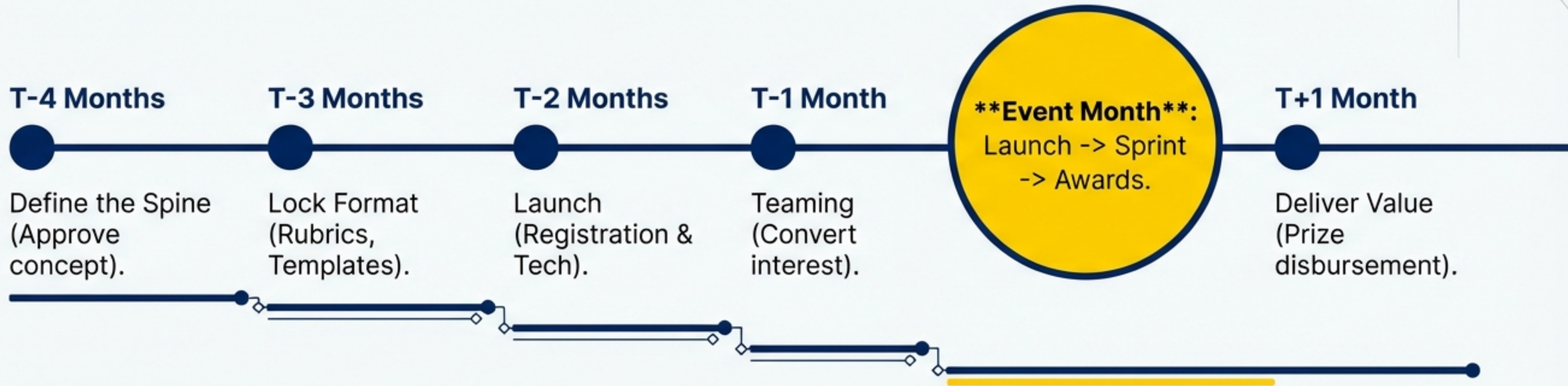
Tier 3: Grant Acceleration Clinic

Baseline Model (\$0 Budget). 4-week structured coaching to turn proposals into external grant applications.

Activation & Engagement Strategy



Execution Roadmap



14 Days to Change a Trajectory



**From Idea to Proposal
From Stranger to Collaborator
From Student to Grant Winner**

A safe space to fail fast, learn quickly, and succeed together.

The Decision



**Approve the
Research-A-Thon Concept.**



**Select Funding Tier
(Cash vs. Grant Package).**



Authorize Date Hold.

Turning a focused
two-week period into
months of momentum
for graduate research.